

GUIDE · AFTER A LOSS

After the loss of a spouse: *a planning checklist.*

The hardest days are not the right time for complicated decisions. This checklist organizes the months that follow into three deliberate phases, so nothing essential is missed and nothing urgent is rushed.

Prepared by **Derek Carrillo, Esq.**

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Move at a humane pace. The items below are a guide, not a to-do list to finish in a week. Your advisor and the attorneys at PEP can carry much of this with you.

IMMEDIATE FOCUS · FIRST DAYS AND WEEKS

- ☐ Take care of yourself and your family first.
- ☐ Create a central folder — physical or digital — for documents.
- ☐ Notify your financial advisor, attorney, tax professional, and insurance agent.
- ☐ Order death certificates (request 10–25 certified copies).
- ☐ Gather key personal and financial documents.
- ☐ Review life insurance and funeral or memorial arrangements.
- ☐ Arrange access to funds for short-term living expenses.
- ☐ Notify the Social Security Administration and the employer, if applicable.

SHORT-TERM FOLLOW-UP · FIRST 1–3 MONTHS

- ☐ Review employer benefits and any final compensation.
- ☐ Secure and retitle bank and investment accounts.
- ☐ Review and address credit cards and outstanding loans.
- ☐ Update real-estate and vehicle titles.
- ☐ Update utilities, subscriptions, and automatic payments.
- ☐ Review and manage digital accounts and access.

LONGER-TERM PLANNING · 3–12 MONTHS

- ☐ Revisit your overall financial and investment strategy.
- ☐ Plan for retirement income and insurance proceeds.
- ☐ Inventory estate assets and household property.
- ☐ Begin estate administration and any required tax filings.
- ☐ Update your own will and healthcare documents.
- ☐ Hold a family financial meeting.

☐ Review charitable, legacy, and educational planning.

☐ Continue attending to your own well-being.

YOU ARE NOT ALONE IN THIS

These decisions are easier with steady guidance. Your financial advisor and the team at Premier Estate Planning can help you work through each phase with care, and handle the legal steps on your behalf.

WORK WITH US

Speak with Derek.

The conversation begins with a complimentary thirty-minute call.



Derek Carrillo, Esq.

Founder & Managing Attorney · Premier Estate Planning

Every plan at Premier Estate Planning is drafted by the attorney whose name is on the engagement letter. If you would like to discuss what an appropriate plan looks like for your family, reach out directly — there is no obligation, and most callers leave the conversation with a clearer sense of their next steps.

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STEP 01

Consultation

A complimentary thirty-minute call to understand your circumstances.

STEP 02

Flat fee in writing

We outline a path forward and quote one fixed fee — no surprises.

STEP 03

Plan in ~2 weeks

Drafting, review, and an in-office signing. You leave with a bound portfolio.

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